Case Context

01

The Business

A digital real estate marketplace in the MENA region, connecting property seekers with listing agents and brokers.

02

The Ask

An independent review of performance since inception: where growth is healthy, where it may be masking weakness, and where the next phase of value lies.

03

The Data

Three linked datasets, Jan 2019–Mar 2022: demand/traffic, client & listings, and revenue.

No campaign-level or lead-quality data available.

The marketplace has scaled rapidly, but the next phase requires both client expansion and stronger account health

The numbers (Q1 2019- Q1 2022)

+292%

Quarterly visits, 3.52M to 13.79M

+252%

Quarterly leads, 426k to 1.5M

3 → 129

Active clients, with listings from 337 to 76,604

112 → 594

Listings per active client

$2.6K → $408K/month

Revenue expanded substantially with increase in revenue/ active client as well

Revenue decline for 33% clients

What it means

The marketplace has scaled materially

Demand, supply and revenue all expanded, so no single lever explains the growth

Existing clients becoming more important to growth; but client health is uneven

Listings grew 111% YoY in Q1 2022, against 28% for clients. But, 42 of 129 retained clients (33%) saw revenue decline, and reduced listings. Decline is particularly pronounced among 24+ month accounts, where average revenue/listings fell 24%/27%.

Supply- Monetization Gap

Listings per client grew to 594 (+111% YoY), but revenue per listing fell 32%, raising questions around pricing, packaging and inventory monetisation

Paid app conversion drop

App lead generation rate fell (20.6% →7.4%) alongside a 56% CPC decline, signalling budget dilution into low-intent clicks

Recommended actions

Package restructuring & monetization

Cap standard listing allowances and introduce high-margin add-ons (Featured/Premium boosts) for high-volume accounts

Targeted recovery playbook for at risk clients

Pre-Renewal ROI Playbook: Deploy Commercial Strategy team ROI audits prior to contract renewal for mature accounts

Improve paid demand efficiency

Reallocate app spend based on Cost Per Qualified Lead (CPQL) and down-funnel intent (WhatsApp/Calls)

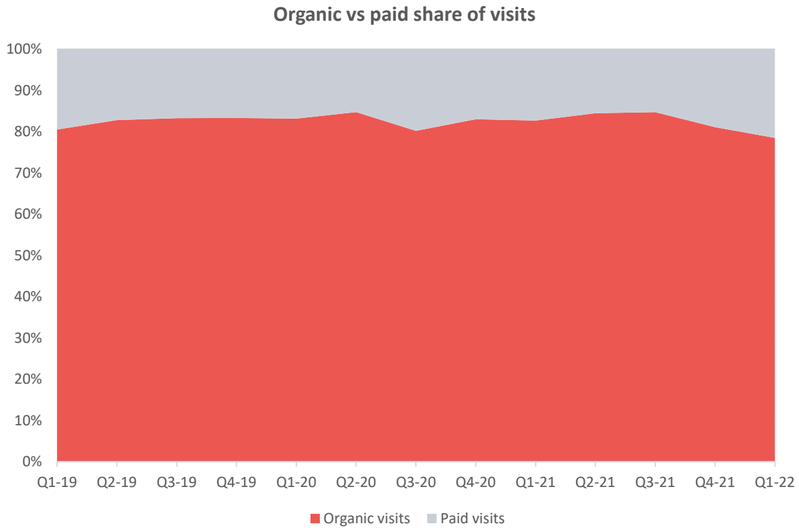
Note: Client 0 excluded from per-client figures- unnamed aggregate row

Demand has scaled largely on organic traffic, and in Q1 2022, visit growth ran well ahead of spend

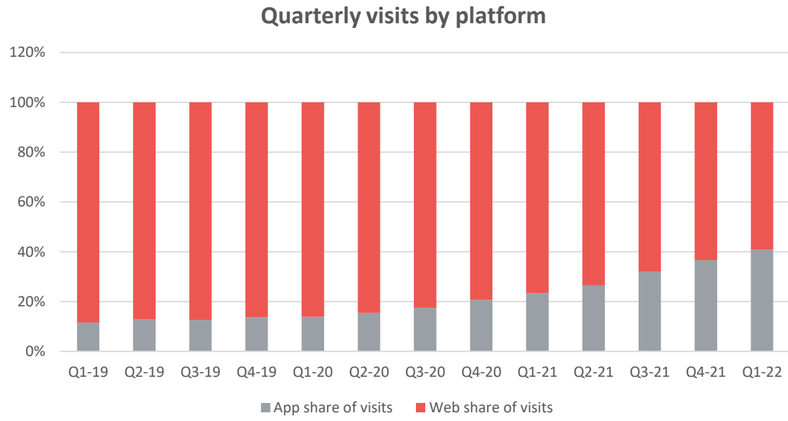
Visits and marketing spend, year-on-year growth



Organic vs paid



Quarterly visits by platform



Full period

Visits **3.52M to 13.79M**

Leads **426K to 1.50M**

Spend **$197K to $771K**

Demand expanded substantially, but the relationship with paid investment is not one-for-one

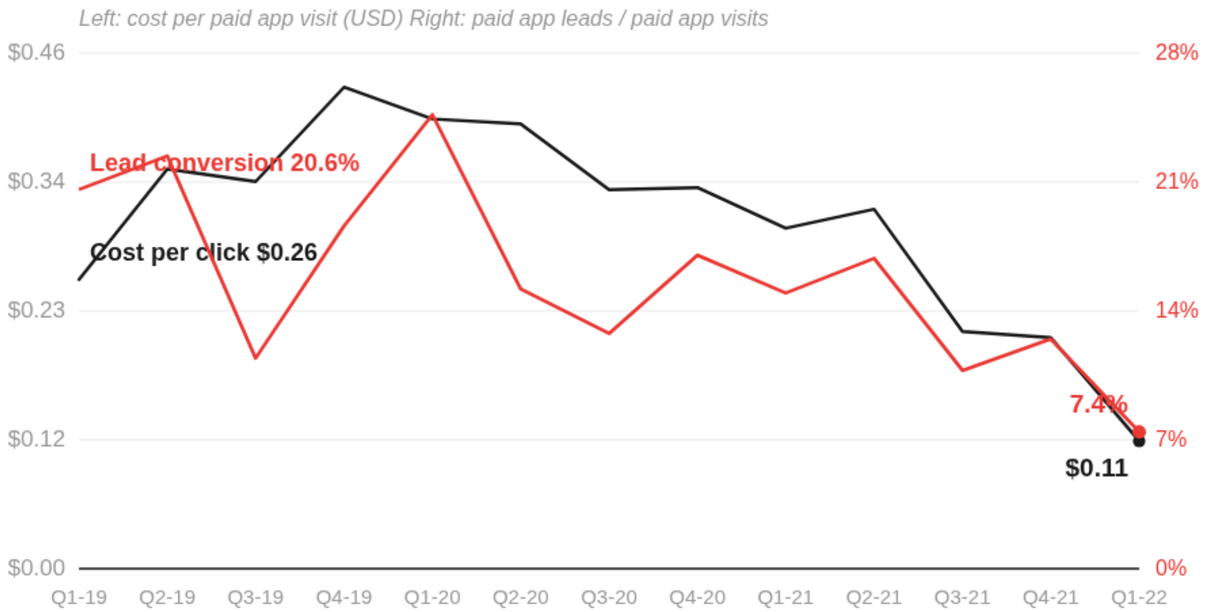
78% organic

Organic stayed the clear majority of traffic in every year, while the platform mix shifted towards app, from 11.5% to 40.9% of visits.

SO WHAT: Protect the ~80% organic traffic engine while shifting paid marketing evaluation from traffic volume to down-funnel lead intent (WhatsApp button clicks & call actions).

Paid app traffic became much cheaper to buy while converting less well, so the open question is conversion efficiency, not spend volume

Paid app: cost per visit and paid lead generation rate, Q1 2019 to Q1 2022



What improved

$0.26 → $0.11
Cost per paid app visit, down 56%

$1.53 vs $2.53
Cost per paid lead in Q1 2022, app versus web

What to investigate

20.6% → 7.4%
Paid app lead generation rate

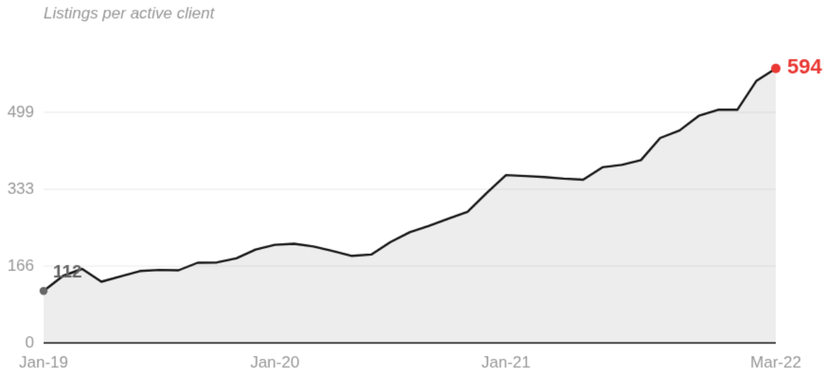
+22%
Cost per paid app lead, $1.25 to $1.53

SO WHAT:

- **Identify source of conversion deterioration:** A 56% drop in CPC alongside a 64% drop in lead conversion (20.6% →7.4%), raises a question around traffic quality, targeting, and user intent
- **Implement Qualified Lead Tracking:** Transition paid app evaluation from raw CPC/clicks to Cost Per Qualified Lead (CPQL) by tracking high-intent down-funnel events (e.g., WhatsApp button clicks, direct phone calls, or scheduled viewing requests) before reallocating budget

Listings are growing four times faster than the client count, while revenue per listing has fallen 32%- creating both an expansion opportunity and a monetisation challenge

Listings per active client, monthly



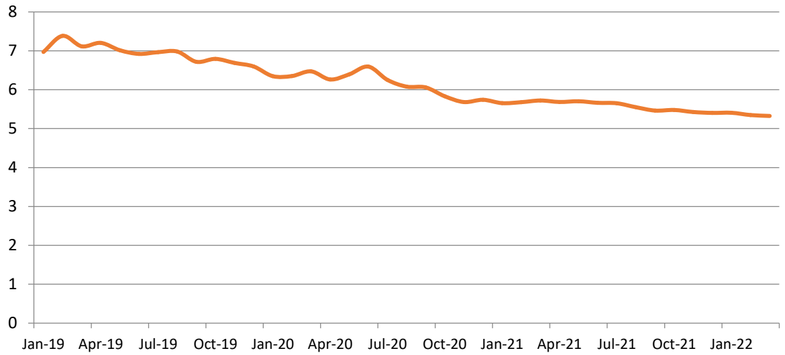
+111% vs +28%

Listings versus clients, March 2022 year on year

337 → 76,604

Total listings on the marketplace

Revenue per listing, market place wide (USD)



$8→ $5

32% decline in revenue per listing

More inventory ≠ proportionally more revenue

The platform is adding listings faster than it is monetising each listing

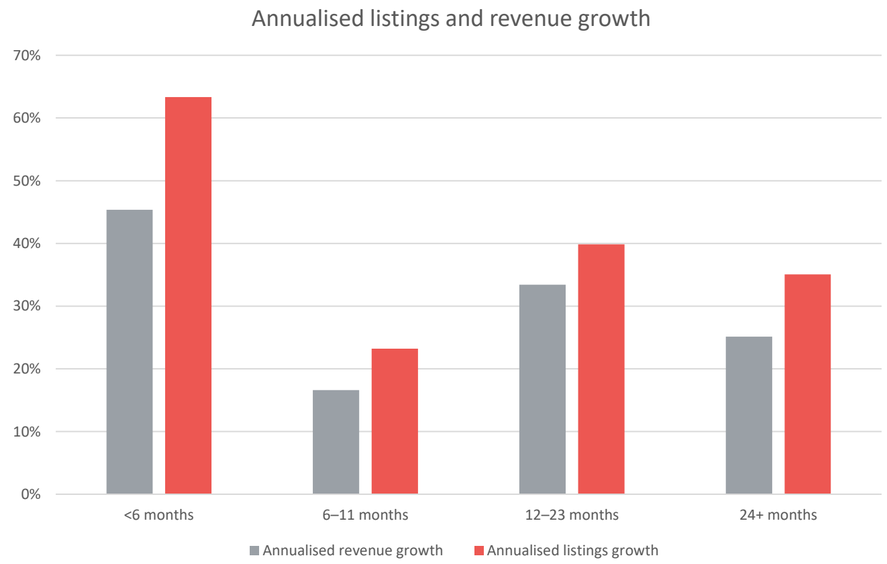
Declining value per listing

- ***What could be driving it?***
  - **Pricing / packaging:** Higher-volume accounts may have lower effective revenue per listing
  - **Client / inventory mix:** Incremental listings may be coming from lower-value inventory or accounts
  - **Value realisation:** Additional listings may not be generating proportionally more demand or ROI
- **Fix**: Segment revenue per listing by client size, package and inventory characteristics before redesigning pricing or packaging.

SO WHAT: Existing-client expansion is an important supply-growth lever; identify accounts with headroom to increase listings and test targeted expansion opportunities. However, review pricing/package economics at higher listing volumes to protect revenue per listing.

Majority of retained clients continue to grow revenue after joining, alongside continued listing expansion

Median growth since joining, by tenure of retained clients



Revenue growth is broad

79 of 129 retained clients saw revenue growth after joining;
42 saw revenue decline and 8 were broadly flat

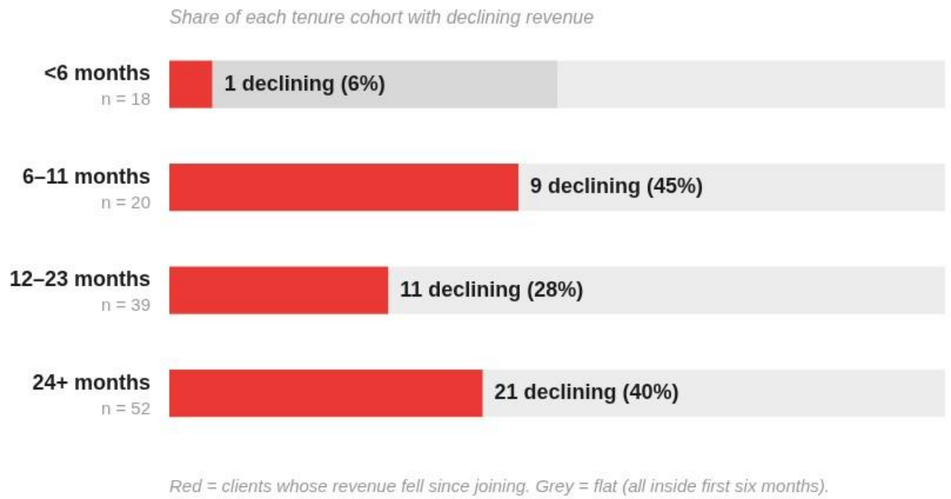
Listing growth remains positive

Median annualised listing growth remained positive across every tenure group, ranging from +23% to +63%

SO WHAT: Retained client growth is driven by listing expansion (+23% to +63% median growth across cohorts). Expansion packages should target healthy mid-tenure clients showing strong organic listing growth and headroom for additional inventory

However, a third of retained clients are shrinking, with mature accounts accounting for half of the decline

Clients with declining revenue since joining, by tenure



Revenue ↓20% | Listings ↓23%

Average growth among the 42 declining-revenue clients

$1,002 vs $3,420

Average monthly revenue, declining versus stable accounts. Decliners are already the smaller accounts

What it costs us today

Value realization risk

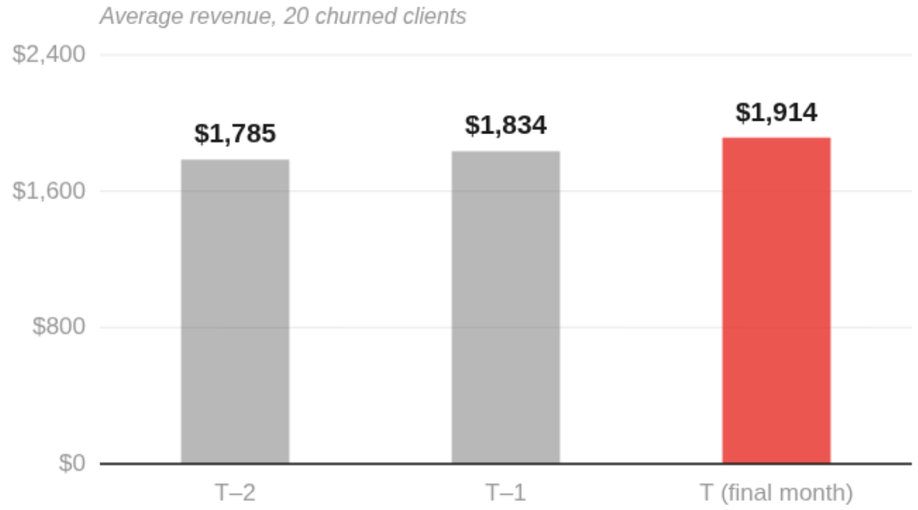
Renewal Window Risk: 40% of mature accounts (24+ months) are experiencing sustained revenue contraction. In a 12-month subscription model, declining listings indicate agents are not realizing sufficient transaction ROI to justify tier upgrades

Commercial Intervention: Run commercial ROI analyses for mature accounts: diagnose listing and revenue contraction, then intervene on ROI, inventory or product adoption

SO WHAT: Prioritise declining accounts for early intervention, with particular focus on mature clients showing sustained revenue and listing contraction

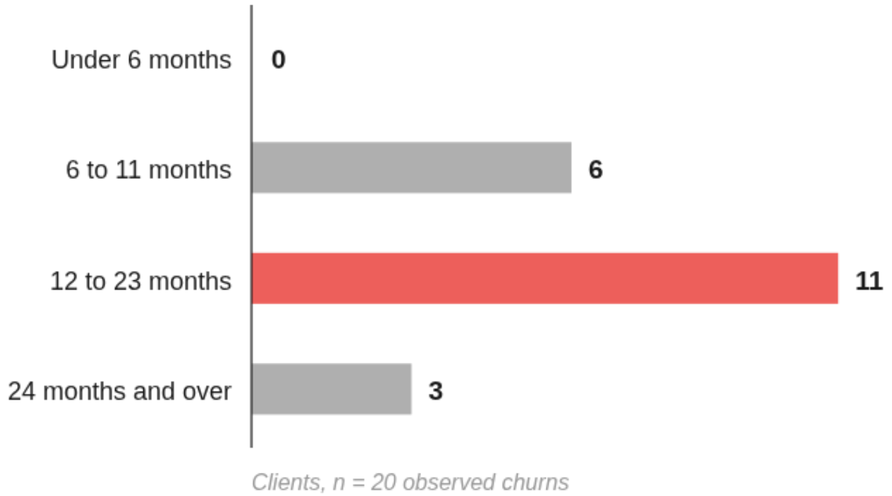
Churn is limited today, but current data does not show a reliable early-warning signal

Average monthly revenue in the final months before churn



Revenue was flat to slightly rising into the final month, and only 4 of the 20 churned clients showed a revenue decline beforehand.

Tenure at the point of churn, 20 clients



No observed churned occurred within the first six months, and 17 of 20 left before month 24

20 of 149
Clients observed to churn, a rate of 13.4%

307 vs 463
Average monthly listings, churned versus active

4 of 20
Showed any revenue decline before leaving

SO WHAT: Build early-warning measurement around client health before committing to a broad retention programme

Note: Observed churn = listings stopped and did not resume through Mar-22; contractual renewal dates were unavailable

Three commercial moves follow from the evidence

Evidence	Implication	Action
01 Monetize account expansion Listings **+111%** against clients **+28%**; listings per active client increased from 112 → 594. But revenue per listing fell 32%.	Existing clients are carrying substantially more inventory, creating an expansion opportunity- but the declining revenue per listing means incremental volume is being monetised less effectively	**Test tiered pricing for high-volume accounts:** protect base package economics and monetize excess inventory through premium listing products
02 Deploy pre- renewal ROI Playbook 42 of 129 retained clients (33%) have lower revenue than at joining; 21 of these are 24+ months old. Declining accounts also show lower listings	A meaningful portion of the existing base is contracting, creating a potential value realisation and future-churn risk pool	**Pre-Renewal Audits:** Run commercial ROI analyses for mature accounts: diagnose listing and revenue contraction, then intervene on ROI, inventory or product adoption
03 Improve paid demand efficiency Paid App cost per visit fell 56%, while paid App LGR fell from 20.6% → 7.4%	Lower-cost traffic has not translated into stronger conversion	**Shift metrics to CPQL:** Track high-intent conversions (calls/WhatsApp) and reallocate performance spend to high-converting ad channels

THE ASK: Test three levers in sequence: monetise incremental inventory, protect mature-account value ahead of renewal, and optimise paid acquisition for qualified leads rather than clicks

Appendix

Basis of analysis, definitions and limitations

Scope of the data

Jan 2019 to Mar 2022

39 months of monthly data. 2022 covers January to March only; YoY comparisons for 2022 therefore used Q1 vs Q1

149 clients

129 retained and 20 churned as at 1 March 2022. Client 0 is an unnamed aggregate row and is excluded from all per-client analysis.

Three source sheets

Demand analysis for visits, leads and spend. CL analysis for clients and listings. Revenue analysis for monthly revenue.

Definitions used

Visit is a session, not a unique user, so repeat visitors are counted more than once.

Lead is a call, email, WhatsApp or connect action taken after viewing a listing.

Active client is a client with at least one listing published in the month.

Churned client is a client whose listings stop and do not resume before March 2022. Individual client renewal dates are not in the dataset; churn is inferred from listings stopping and not resuming, using a general 12-month contract cycle as context

Client growth is measured from each client's own joining month, not from a fixed calendar date.

Limitations to bear in mind

Carried-forward values. In 48% of consecutive month pairs a client's figures repeat the prior month exactly, so month-on-month movements are indicative only. Quarterly and annual views are used throughout.

Duplicate app visits. June and July figures in 2019 and 2021 repeat, affecting roughly 170,000 visits in each year.

Small 2019 base. Only three clients were active in January 2019, so full-period per-client ratios are not meaningful and are avoided.

No campaign data. Targeting, creative and intent are not supplied, so the app conversion change is reported as a question rather than a cause.